

Task - 11: Phishing Attack Simulation & Detection

Internship Task – Elevate Labs

This task focused on understanding phishing attacks and learning how phishing campaigns are simulated and detected. The main objective was to gain awareness of social engineering attacks and methods used to identify and prevent them.

1. Introduction to Phishing Attacks

Phishing is a social engineering attack where attackers trick users into revealing sensitive information such as login credentials, personal data, or financial details by pretending to be a trusted entity.

2. Understanding Phishing Techniques

Phishing attacks commonly use: - Fake emails pretending to be from legitimate organizations - Malicious links directing users to fake websites - Urgent messages that pressure users to act quickly

3. Phishing Simulation Setup

A phishing simulation was designed using tools like GoPhish or manual phishing templates. A fake email template was created to resemble a legitimate communication.

4. Landing Page Configuration

A fake landing page was set up to capture user interaction. This helped understand how attackers collect information from victims.

5. Sending Test Phishing Emails

Test phishing emails were sent in a controlled environment. Responses such as email opens and link clicks were tracked for analysis.

6. Tracking and Analyzing Responses

User responses were monitored to understand phishing effectiveness. This showed how easily users can fall victim to phishing attacks.

7. Identifying Phishing Red Flags

Common phishing indicators include: - Suspicious sender addresses - Unexpected attachments or links - Spelling and grammar mistakes - Urgent or threatening language

8. Phishing Prevention Methods

- User awareness and training - Email filtering solutions - Avoid clicking unknown links - Verifying sender identity

9. Documentation of Simulation

All steps, observations, and outcomes of the phishing simulation were documented clearly. Proper documentation helps improve organizational security awareness.

Learning Outcome

Through this task, I gained practical knowledge of phishing attacks and detection methods. I learned how phishing campaigns are created, how users are targeted, and how awareness and preventive measures can reduce social engineering risks.